

DELAYED FLIGHT

JUNE 2019

CoC appoints Grant Thornton's Ashish Chhawchharia as Insolvency Resolution Professional

OCTOBER 2020

CoC approves the resolution plan jointly submitted by businessmen Murari Lal Jalan and Florian Fritsch

LATE 2022

Planned re-launch

FLEET SIZE

Nil (Current)

PROPOSED FLEET SIZE

Plans to launch with six aircraft, and progressively increase it to 120 in five years

BUSINESS MODEL

Full-service carrier

OBTAINS AOC

May 2022

EXPIRY OF AOC

May 2023*

LOSS OF IATA CODE

September 2023

AOC: Air operator's certificate;
*DGCA had extended the carrier's AOC till September 9 subject to it meeting certain conditions. Now, Jet needs to apply for re-certification

Source Industry, DGCA

committed to adhering to it," assures the person, who is familiar with the developments. Former employees see this as imperative. "The prompt settlement of employee dues in alignment with NCLAT directives and ratified by the Supreme Court represents not a mere stride, but a bond towards legitimacy," says Narayan Hariharan, former Senior VP of HR at Jet Airways, and currently advisor to the staff and officers' association that has been fighting court cases to get the employees' claims resolved.

MIXED SIGNALS

In May, the airline's Air Operator's Certificate (AOC), granted a year earlier, expired. In yet another setback, the airline lost the two-letter designator code awarded by the International Air Transport Association (IATA), a global trade body of airlines, for remaining non-operational. Amid such setbacks, India's aviation regulator Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) had conditionally extended Jet Airways' AOC until September 9. Now, the re-certification process may take anywhere between four to six months. "Assuming the judicial proceedings

JKC HAS INVESTED ₹250 CRORE IN JET AIRWAYS, AND MUST SPEND ₹100 CRORE BY SEPTEMBER 30 TO TAKE CONTROL OF THE CARRIER

and IBC matters are all closed, and the re-certification completed in a manner conducive to the restart of operations, Jet Airways 2.0 then has to cross a number of other hurdles," says Satyendra Pandey, Managing Partner at aviation advisory firm AT-TV. These range from hiring staff members and entering a market that is witnessing intense competition, to fleet acquisition and slot allocations. "Even in the most optimistic scenarios, the first flight is unlikely to take off before January 2024."

Legal experts, however, see the potential for a gainful revival due to the goodwill enjoyed by the Jet Airways brand. Other than ironing out the differences with lenders, JKC also needs to address liquidity issues and, most critically, secure the support of the international lessor community. "Jet Airways was a trusted brand with reasonable goodwill, but the new management will need to find ways to tackle the liquidity issues," says Ajay Kumar, Managing Partner at Gurugram-based law firm KLA Legal. "People in the industry and travellers, in general, would love to see Jet fly again. After Go First filed for voluntary bankruptcy, airfares have seen a steep rise. India has the appetite to absorb another good airline, and Jet just fits the bill."